elk fleet server setup

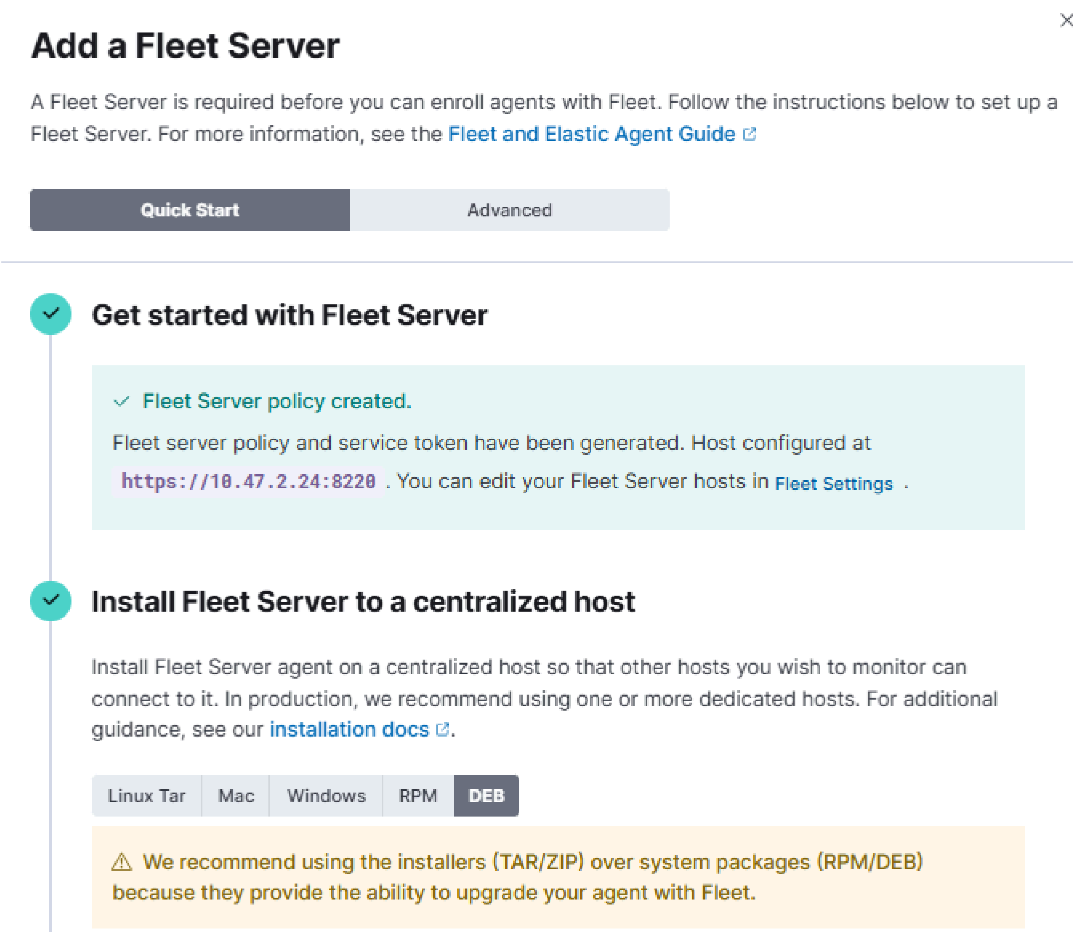
Prerequisites

- **Elasticsearch & Kibana:** Already installed and running (version 8.x recommended).
- **Network:** The Fleet Server host must be able to reach Elasticsearch on port `9200` and Kibana on port `5601` .
- **Connectivity:** Other agents must be able to reach the Fleet Server on port `8220` .

Step 1: Configure Fleet Settings in Kibana

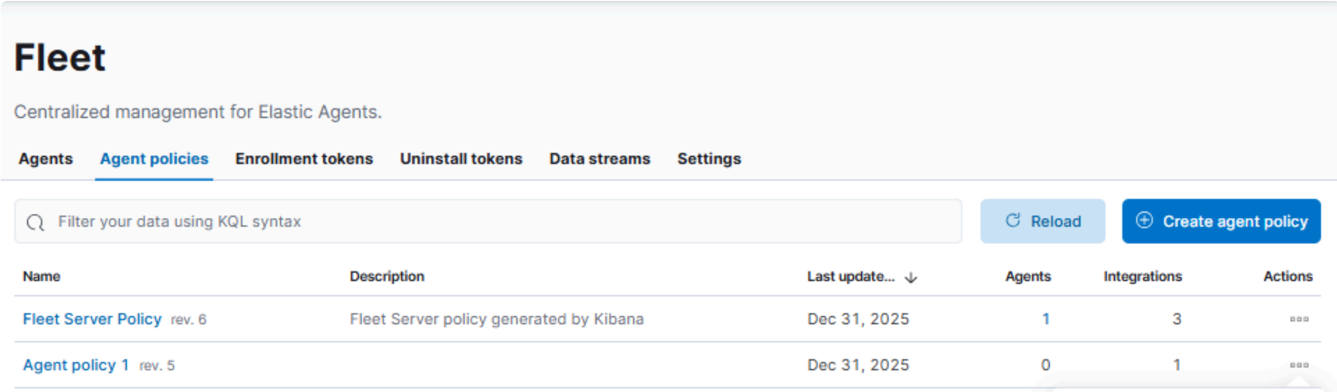
Before installing the server, you need to tell Kibana where the Fleet Server and Elasticsearch are located.

1. Open **Kibana** and navigate to **Management > Fleet**.
2. Click on the **Settings** tab.
3. **Fleet Server hosts:** Click "Edit" and add the URL of your Fleet Server (e.g., `https://<fleet-server-ip>:8220`).
4. **Elasticsearch hosts:** Ensure the URL of your Elasticsearch instance is correct (e.g., `https://<elasticsearch-ip>:9200`).
5. Click **Save and apply settings**.



Step 2: Create a Fleet Server Policy

1. In the **Fleet** menu, go to the **Agent policies** tab.
2. Click **Create agent policy**.
3. Name it (e.g., `Fleet Server Policy`) and ensure **Collect system logs and metrics** is selected.
4. After creating it, click on the policy and select **Add integration**.
5. Search for **Fleet Server**, click it, and then click **Add Fleet Server**. Use the default settings and save.



Step 3: Generate the Installation Command

1. Go back to **Fleet > Agents** and click **Add agent**.
2. Under "Select an agent policy," choose the **Fleet Server Policy** you just created.
3. Select the **"Install Fleet Server onto a central host"** option.
4. Kibana will provide a command-line script. **Copy this script.** It will look like this:

```
curl -L -O https://artifacts.elastic.co/downloads/beats/elastic-agent/elastic-agent-8.13.1-
amd64.deb
sudo dpkg -i elastic-agent-8.13.1-amd64.deb
sudo elastic-agent enroll
\ --fleet-server-es=https://10.47.2.26:9200
\ --fleet-server-service-
token=AAEAAWVsYXN0aWMvZmxlZXQtc2VydmVyL3Rva2VuLTE3NjcxNjk1NDI0Njc6VWczei1wQi1TcFN3TlowVmU4cnl
kUQ
\ --fleet-server-policy=fleet-server-policy
\ --fleet-server-es-ca-trusted-
fingerprint=52aadb47e41f6cb53790fd6eaf5c28c065d5e45783e5d1be9029e1b078fa5ab1
\ --fleet-server-port=8220 sudo systemctl enable elastic-agent sudo systemctl start elastic-
agent
```

Step 4: Install the Agent on the Host

1. Log into the Linux machine intended to be your Fleet Server.
2. Download the **Elastic Agent** package for your OS from the [Elastic downloads page].
3. Extract the package: `tar xzvf elastic-agent-8.x.x-linux-x86_64.tar.gz` .
4. Navigate into the directory: `cd elastic-agent-8.x.x-linux-x86_64` .
5. **Run the command** you copied from Kibana in Step 3.

> **If you are using self-signed certificates and the installation fails due to SSL, you may need to add the `--fleet-server-es-ca` flag pointing to your CA certificate file.**

Step 5: Verify the Setup

1. Go back to **Kibana > Fleet > Agents**.
2. You should now see your Fleet Server listed with a status of **Healthy**.
3. You can now begin adding other Elastic Agents to your network using the "Add Agent" button and choosing a standard agent policy.

```
The programs included with the Kali GNU/Linux system are free software;
the exact distribution terms for each program are described in the
individual files in /usr/share/doc/*/copyright.

Kali GNU/Linux comes with ABSOLUTELY NO WARRANTY, to the extent
permitted by applicable law.
Last login: Wed Dec 31 12:54:12 2025 from 27.116.54.53
┌──(kali㉿kali)-[~]
└─$ sudo su
[sudo] password for kali:
┌──(root㉿kali)-[/home/kali]
└─# curl -L -O https://artifacts.elastic.co/downloads/beats/elastic-agent/elastic-agent-8.13.1-amd64.deb
  % Total    % Received % Xferd  Average Speed   Time    Time     Time  Current
                                 Dload  Upload   Total   Spent    Left  Speed
100 556.4M 100 556.4M    0     0  2761k      0  0:03:26  0:03:26 --:--:--  3133k

┌──(root㉿kali)-[/home/kali]
└─# |
```

```
┌──(root㉿kali)-[/home/kali]
└─# sudo dpkg -i elastic-agent-8.13.1-amd64.deb
(Reading database ... 636192 files and directories currently installed.)
Preparing to unpack elastic-agent-8.13.1-amd64.deb ...
Unpacking elastic-agent (8.13.1) over (8.13.1) ...
found symlink /usr/share/elastic-agent/bin/elastic-agent, unlink
systemd daemon-reload
Setting up elastic-agent (8.13.1) ...
create symlink /usr/share/elastic-agent/bin/elastic-agent to /var/lib/elastic-agent/data/elastic-agent-8.13.1-379dfc/ela
stic-agent
Processing triggers for kali-menu (2025.3.2) ...
```

Fleet

Centralized management for Elastic Agents.

Agents | **Agent policies** | **Enrollment tokens** | **Uninstall tokens** | **Data streams** | **Settings**

Ingest Overview Metrics | Agent Info Metrics | Agent activity | Add Fleet Server | Add agent

Filter your data using KQL syntax | Status 4 | Tags 0 | Agent policy 2 | Upgrade available

Showing 1 agent | Clear filters | Healthy 1 | Unhealthy 0 | Updating 0 | Offline 0

Status	Host	Agent policy	CPU	Memory	Last activity	Version	Actions
Healthy	kali	Fleet Server Policy rev. 6	309.89 %	387 MB	10 seconds ago	8.13.1	···

Rows per page: 20 | 1

Auto interval | No breakdown

Dec 31, 2025 @ 00:00:00.000 - Dec 31, 2025 @ 23:59:59.999 (interval: Auto - 30 minutes)

Documents (3,497) | **Field statistics** | Sort fields 1

@timestamp	Document
Dec 31, 2025 @ 16:22:17.401	**@timestamp** Dec 31, 2025 @ 16:22:17.401 **agent.ephemeral_id** 1fbb2d0f-c077-411c-a42e-3b3155f0e688 **agent.id** d756717d-0fa1-47ed-8a3e-f4da7785fb36 **agent.name** kali **agent.type** filebeat **agent.version** 8.13.1 **component.binary** fleet-server **component.dataset** elastic_agent.fleet_server **component.id** fleet-server-default **component.type** fleet-server **data_stream.dataset** elastic_agent.fleet_server **data_stream.namespace** default **data_stream.type** logs **ecs.version** 8.0.…
Dec 31, 2025 @ 16:22:14.968	**@timestamp** Dec 31, 2025 @ 16:22:14.968 **agent.ephemeral_id** 1fbb2d0f-c077-411c-a42e-3b3155f0e688 **agent.id** d756717d-0fa1-47ed-8a3e-f4da7785fb36 **agent.name** kali **agent.type** filebeat **agent.version** 8.13.1 **component.binary** filebeat **component.dataset** elastic_agent.filebeat **component.id** udp-default **component.type** udp **data_stream.dataset** elastic_agent.filebeat **data_stream.namespace** default **data_stream.type** logs **ecs.version** 8.0.0 **elastic_agent.id** d756717d-0fa1-47ed-…
Dec 31, 2025 @ 16:22:11.962	**@timestamp** Dec 31, 2025 @ 16:22:11.962 **agent.ephemeral_id** 1fbb2d0f-c077-411c-a42e-3b3155f0e688 **agent.id** d756717d-0fa1-47ed-8a3e-f4da7785fb36 **agent.name** kali **agent.type** filebeat **agent.version** 8.13.1 **component.binary** fleet-server **component.dataset** elastic_agent.fleet_server **component.id** fleet-server-default **component.type** fleet-server **data_stream.dataset** elastic_agent.fleet_server **data_stream.namespace** default **data_stream.type** logs **ecs.version** 8.0.…
Dec 31, 2025 @ 16:22:06.528	**@timestamp** Dec 31, 2025 @ 16:22:06.528 **agent.ephemeral_id** 1fbb2d0f-c077-411c-a42e-3b3155f0e688 **agent.id** d756717d-0fa1-47ed-8a3e-f4da7785fb36 **agent.name** kali **agent.type** filebeat **agent.version** 8.13.1 **component.binary** fleet-server **component.dataset** elastic_agent.fleet_server **component.id** fleet-server-default **component.type** fleet-server **data_stream.dataset** elastic_agent.fleet_server **data_stream.namespace** default **data_stream.type** logs **ecs.version** 8.0.…
Dec 31, 2025 @ 16:22:01.102	**@timestamp** Dec 31, 2025 @ 16:22:01.102 **agent.ephemeral_id** 1fbb2d0f-c077-411c-a42e-3b3155f0e688 **agent.id** d756717d-0fa1-47ed-8a3e-f4da7785fb36 **agent.name** kali **agent.type** filebeat **agent.version** 8.13.1 **component.binary** fleet-server **component.dataset** elastic_agent.fleet_server **component.id** fleet-server-default **component.type** fleet-server **data_stream.dataset** elastic_agent.fleet_server **data_stream.namespace** default **data_stream.type** logs **ecs.version** 8.0.…
Dec 31, 2025 @ 16:21:55.641	**@timestamp** Dec 31, 2025 @ 16:21:55.641 **agent.ephemeral_id** 1fbb2d0f-c077-411c-a42e-3b3155f0e688 **agent.id** d756717d-0fa1-47ed-8a3e-f4da7785fb36 **agent.name** kali **agent.type** filebeat **agent.version** 8.13.1 **component.binary** fleet-server **component.dataset** elastic_agent.fleet_server **component.id** fleet-server-default **component.type** fleet-server **data_stream.dataset** elastic_agent.fleet_server **data_stream.namespace** default **data_stream.type** logs **ecs.version** 8.0.…